

TRIBE WINS OPENER

Loaded Denver Can't 'Bear It'

By JEP CADOU JR., Sports Editor

Denver came to town loaded for bear. But Barry Latman's two-hitter made Andy Cohen a ruined bruin.

That was the story of the Indianapolis Indians' 1958 season opener in a nutshell.

The 5,184 paying customers at Victory Field were treated to a couple of mid-season-type pitching performances by Latman and Ben Flowers, who allowed only six hits for Denver.

The fans were kept in a state of mounting suspense for seven innings and part of the eighth before Latman, yielded his first base hit, a clean single to right by John Blanchard.

THIS WAS NO ordinary ball game. It wasn't even an ordinary season opener. It had all the elements. Cohen, who managed the Indians in 1957, and is directing the Denver operations this trip, was pitted against Walker Cooper, great St. Louis Cardinals "Gas House Gang" catcher who was managing his first game—and also catching in it, for good measure.

And, at stake was a large, lethargic bear with a \$10-a-day appetite. This somnolent specimen (he dozed in serene splendor beside the Indians dugout during pregame ceremonies) was Denver's for the taking had it, won, last night. The Denver entry in the American Association is known as the Bears and Indians' promotion manager Bill Warren figured they need a mascot.

The stunt was such a success that Warren is considering putting the bear up for grabs by Cohen & Co. again tonight.

WHILE THE crowd certainly won't win Indianapolis the Association attendance trophy, General Manager Ray Johnston said, "We're not disappointed. When the fans see how this club plays, they'll be out."

Johnston probably said a mouthful. The Indians were highly impressive in their 2-0 victory. They hustled all the way. Even Cooper, a 42-year-old who weighs in the

neighborhood of 250, legged it in from second base like an ambitious rookie after doubling in the seventh.

They played errorless ball in the field—except for one harmless bobble by Cooper who let a pop foul fly get away from him in the sixth.

LATMAN, accepting congratulations from his teammates, told writers that both the Denver hits, by Blanchard and by George Wilson with two out in the ninth, came on fast balls.

The one which broke up his no-hitter was "a fast one up around his (Blanchard's) eyes." Latman said.

It was a great turnabout for Latman, who pitched a four-hitter in the season opener here last year only to lose it to Stu Miller, who hurled hitless ball for Minneapolis in a game called after six innings because of rain.

Cooper, one of the few managers in organized baseball with a perfect record (unbeaten and unscored on), beamed all over the clubhouse after the game.

"Latman was mixing them up real fine," Cooper said. But it took Cohen to bring out another highly salient point: "That guy behind the plate was doing a lot of pitching, too. We sure could have used him at Indianapolis last year."

The Weather

Joe Crow Says:

In the outer space power game Russia opened with a pair (of sputniks) but the U.S. called their hand and came up with three of a kind.



Indianapolis and Indiana — Generally fair today; fair and continued mild tomorrow.